Developing an Appreciative Working Climate

Appreciation as part of organizational culture

This webinar brings together research and practitioner experience to examine how appreciation is experienced at work and how organizations can make it part of everyday culture. Appreciation is not limited to formal awards or praise from senior leaders. It can come from managers, colleagues, organizational leaders and customers, and can be communicated through recognition, respect, trust, meaningful work and opportunities to contribute.

The research presented includes a survey of employees working in Germany. On a seven-point scale, 55.6% of respondents rated appreciation from their manager at the top end of the scale, and 58.8% did so for appreciation from colleagues. The presenters also note that more than 40% did not regularly receive appreciation from a manager or coworker. These findings describe the surveyed group, not all employees.

The session reports that manager appreciation is associated with job satisfaction and some forms of contribution beyond formal duties; appreciation from coworkers is associated with organizational identification and helping colleagues. Employees also value some contributions, such as willingness to take responsibility, more than they feel those contributions are recognized. Appreciation therefore needs to be sincere and aligned with what employees actually value.

What this means for practice

- Make recognition part of regular routines: feedback conversations, team meetings and acknowledgement of everyday contributions.
- Equip managers to listen, show respect and recognize contributions fairly.
- Reinforce appreciation through organizational stories, structures and reward practices, not campaigns alone.
- Address working conditions and power dynamics that prevent people from contributing or feeling seen.

Using a cultural framework, the webinar argues that an appreciative climate is built through repeated practices and organizational choices. Communication can support that work, but cannot substitute for it.

Source: “Developing an Appreciative Working Climate” transcript.